

computer to control test instruments using any of these interfaces.

Test instruments include:

1. Measurement instruments to measure electrical characteristics
2. Stimulus instruments to generate electronic signals
3. Digital instruments to read and write digital patterns
4. Power instruments using power sources
5. Switching instruments to route electrical signals to different points

The adaptor, also referred to as interface test adaptor, routes signals from the test system to the UUT, which is the target of the ATE. Under software control, the computer performs test sequences and procedures to determine whether the UUT is performing according to its specifications. The tasks required are controlling the test instruments, routing signals to various test points in the UUT, and measuring UUT responses. ATEasy provides all the tools required during the development, debugging and integration of test sequences and procedures.

Running on Microsoft Windows, ATEasy provides a familiar GUI combined with the flexibility of an object-oriented programming environment. Users of Microsoft Visual Basic or Visual C++ will feel right at home. Supporting any instrument, regardless of its interface, ATEasy develops an ATE application in a single integrated environment. With specialised features designed for testing and instrument control applications, it can also be used for data acquisition, process control, lab applications, calibration and any application requiring instrument control. ATEasy supports many instrument interfaces including VXI, GPIB (IEEE-488), RS-232/422, PC boards, PXI and LXI (TCP/IP).

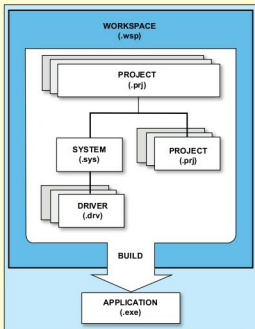


Fig. 2: A workspace, its project file, program, system and driver modules

ATEasy's IDE is object-oriented and data-driven. It automatically selects editing tools according to the type of the object to be created or modified. This feature simplifies programming as you merely click an object and ATEasy automatically selects the appropriate tool.

Features

The ATEasy IDE includes tools for creating instrument drivers, user interface, tests, documentation, test executives, report generation and anything else you need to create T&M applications—all with point-and-click and drag-and-drop ease.

ATEasy contains a high-level programming language enabling test engineers, electronics engineers and programmers to develop and integrate applications of any scale—small to large, and simple to complex. The ATEasy

programming language allows user-defined statements to be used along with flow control, procedures, variables and other common items found in most programming languages. It is flexible and powerful, yet easy-to-use and self-documenting.

Professional programmers will appreciate ATEasy's programming language offering DLL calling, 'C' header file import for DLL function prototyping, OLE/COM/ActiveX control support, .NET assemblies, LabVIEW virtual instruments or their libraries, function panel instrument driver files (used mostly by LabWindows/CVI), multi-threading, exception handling, and many more software components and standards for developing complex applications in a truly open system architecture.

ATEasy's programming language also contains many built-in programming elements to simplify programming, allowing non-programmers to easily use ATEasy for application development.

The unique design of ATEasy provides a structured and integrated framework for developing reusable components and modules that you can easily maintain and debug. These components can be reused from application to application, reducing the time and effort of developing and maintaining applications. The developer is given a framework that is especially designed for a T&M application. The framework contains predefined components designed for interfaces (such as GPIB), instruments control and drivers, system configura-

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